



higher education & training

Department:
Higher Education and Training
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)
ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE
(First paper)
NQF LEVEL 2

(4101102)

13 November 2025 (X-paper)
09:00–11:00

This question paper consists of 12 pages.

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REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA
NATIONAL CERTIFICATE (VOCATIONAL)
ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE
NQF LEVEL 2
(First paper)
TIME: 2 HOURS
MARKS: 140

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of FIVE sections:

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION
SECTION B: SUMMARY
SECTION C: READING AND VIEWING
SECTION D: LANGUAGE PRACTICE
SECTION E: COMMUNICATION IN PRACTICE
 2. Answer all the questions.
 3. Read all the questions carefully.
 4. Number the answers according to the numbering system used in this question paper.
 5. Start each section on a new page.
 6. Use only a black or blue pen.
 7. All the work that you do not want to be marked must be crossed out.
 8. Write neatly and legibly.
-

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

Five key takeaways from the budget

SOWETAN LIVE

BY JEANETTE CHABALALA - 12 March 2025 - 14:59



Enoch Godongwana, the finance minister, presented his much awaited budget in Cape Town's parliament on Wednesday afternoon.

Here are five things that came out from the budget:

VAT increase:

The government has proposed increasing VAT by 0,5 percentage points in 2025/26 and another 0,5 percentage points in 2026/27, bringing the VAT rate to 16%. Godongwana said there will be no inflationary adjustments to personal income tax brackets, rebates, and medical tax credits, raising an additional R28bn in 2025/26 and R14,5bn in 2026/27.

Debt:

Godongwana said the government debt is projected to stabilise at 76,2% of GDP in 2025/26, with the budget deficit narrowing to 3,5% by 2027/28. He said debt-service costs remain a concern, consuming R389,6bn, which is 22 cents of every rand raised in revenue.

Infrastructure investments:

Over R1 trillion will be allocated to public infrastructure over the next three years. This includes R402bn for transport and logistics, R219,2bn for energy infrastructure, and R156,3bn for water and sanitation. The Passenger Rail Agency of SA will receive an additional R19,2bn for rail infrastructure, while the SA National Roads Agency will spend R100bn over the medium term to keep the network in good condition.

2)

-4-

Public sector wages:

Godongwana said an additional R28,9bn will be allocated to retain 9 300 healthcare workers and 800 post-community service doctors. He said R19,1bn would be added over the medium term to keep about 11 000 teachers in classrooms. Regarding early childhood development, the minister said the subsidy has not increased from the 2019 level of R17 per child per day, and to remedy this, an additional R10bn over the medium term is allocated to increase the subsidy to R24 per day per child.

Social grants:

Social grants will increase, with old age and disability grants rising by R130, child support grants by R30 and foster care grants by R70. The social relief of distress grant that was introduced during the Covid-19 pandemic has been extended by a year to end in March 2026, with R35,2bn allocated for this. Godongwana said the future form and nature of the grant will be informed by the outcome of the review of active labour market programmes.

- 1.1 Explain the meaning of the heading: 'Five key takeaways from the budget'. (2)
- 1.2 Refer to the statement, "Enoch Godongwana, the finance minister, presented his much awaited budget in Cape Town's parliament on Wednesday afternoon."
 - 1.2.1 Why is the budget much awaited? (2)
 - 1.2.2 Who is awaiting it? (1)
- 1.3 What is the total increase in VAT for the 2025/26 cycle? (1)
- 1.4 Write out the following abbreviations in full:
 - 1.4.1 SANRAL
 - 1.4.2 VAT (2)
- 1.5 According to the Minister of Finance, Mr Godongwane, what will happen to the personal income tax brackets? (2)

2)

1.6

Choose a term from COLUMN B that matches a description in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–E) next to the question number (1.6.1–1.6.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B	
1.6.1	An amount that has to be paid or spent to buy or obtain something.	A	rebates
1.6.2	Cash payments provided by the government to support vulnerable individuals and families.	B	debt
1.6.3	A partial refund to someone who has paid too much for tax, rent, or a utility.	C	revenue
1.6.4	The money generated from normal business operations, calculated as the average sales price times the number of units sold.	D	costs
1.6.5	A sum of money that is owed or due.	E	social grants

(5 × 1)

(5)

1.7 Indicate whether the following statements are TRUE or FALSE by only writing 'True' or 'False' next to the question number (1.7.1–1.7.2). Give a reason to support your answer.

1.7.1 One billion is equal to a hundred million.

1.7.2 Most of the budget was allocated to infrastructure and development.

(2 × 2)

(4)

1.8 Why do you think the government debt concerns the Finance Minister?

(2)

1.9 Indicate whether each statement is a FACT or OPINION by writing only 'Fact' or 'Opinion' next to the question number. Give a reason for your answer.

1.9.1 The 2025 budget is the best budget presented by the Minister of Finance in South Africa.

1.8.2 The budget was presented to the South African public in Cape Town on Wednesday, 12 March 2025.

(2 × 2)

(4)

1.10 In your own words, what are *public sector wages*?

(2)

1.11 Do you think it is important for the government to allocate a budget for social grants? Give a reason to substantiate your answer.

(3)

[30]

TOTAL SECTION A:

30

2)

-6-

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

The article below focuses on budgeting. Read the passage and draw a mind map in your ANSWER BOOK to summarise FOUR benefits of budgeting.

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Your mind map should have ONE central idea and FOUR supporting facts
2. Use half an A4 page to draw the mind map
3. Use your OWN WORDS as much as possible.
4. Your mind map must be presented neatly.

CONTENT	LAYOUT	GRAMMAR/STYLE	TOTAL
5	3	2	10

What are the benefits of budgeting?

Knowing that you have a good budget to fall back on each month will give you the confidence and peace of mind of knowing you're in control of your money. It beats the 'spend and hope' approach, where you don't pay attention to your bank balance and hope there is money left in your account when you come to pay.

Planning for the future and working toward an objective allows you to plan big purchases, like houses and cars, without worrying that you'll miss the mark. Sticking to your budget and putting money aside will bring you closer to achieving your financial goals.

You'll be surprised at how much you spend on essentials like bills, rent/mortgage, and food. Most of us will have vastly underestimated our monthly or weekly spending by forgetting how much we spend on other items like TV licenses and commuting.

The budget planner helps you stay on top of your spending, but what about the money you put away or use to pay off debts? A good budget will inform you when your debts will be paid off and identify when you may have additional money to redirect into savings or spend on an occasional treat.

[10]

[Adapted from: <https://www.cabotfinancial.co.uk/>]

TOTAL SECTION B: 10

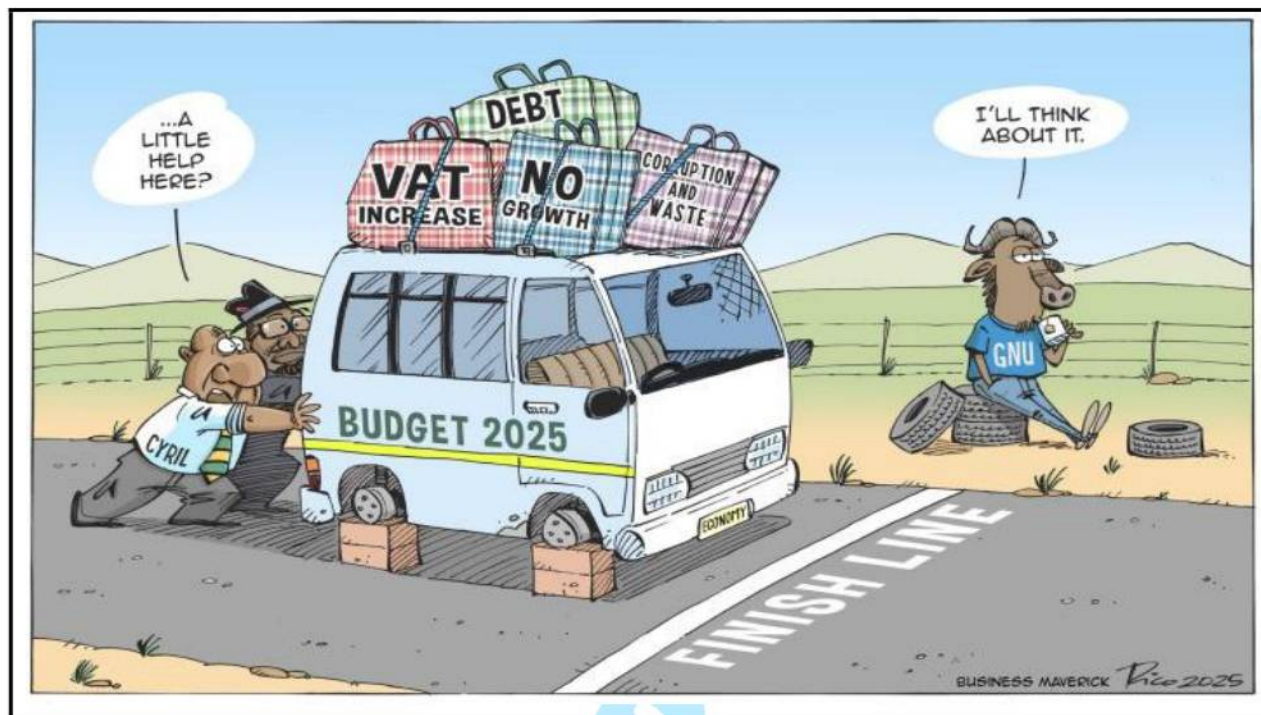
2)

-7-

SECTION C: READING AND VIEWING

QUESTION 3

Study the cartoon below and answer the questions that follow.



- 3.1 What is the message being conveyed in this cartoon? (2)
- 3.2
 - 3.2.1 Who are the people behind the car? (1)
 - 3.2.2 What are the people behind the car doing? Answer this question based on the message of the cartoon. (2)
- 3.3 Comment on the irony used in the cartoon. (3)
- 3.4 Refer to the statement, "I'LL THINK ABOUT IT."
 - 3.4.1 What does the acronym GNU stand for? (1)
 - 3.4.2 What will he 'THINK' about? (2)
- 3.5 The GNU is sitting on the tyres.
 - 3.5.1 Where did he/she get the tyres? (1)
 - 3.5.2 What does the fact that he/she is sitting on the tyres symbolise? (2)
- 3.6 Why is the luggage placed on top of the car while the car is empty inside? (3)

[17]

2)

-8-

QUESTION 4

Study the advertisement below and answer the questions that follow.

30 YEARS OF FREEDOM

Free State Welcomes
the 30 Years of Democracy Bus

30 YEARS OF DEMOCRACY PARTNERSHIP AND GROWTH

THURSDAY, 25 JULY 2024
Hoffman Square, Bloemfontein
08:00

The Democracy Bus Project forms an integral part of South African Government's 30 Years of Freedom and Democracy campaign implementation, ending March 2025.

OBJECTIVES

- Mobilise the country to celebrate the gains, achievements, and the milestone of 30 years of democratic rule and living in a free and democratic society.
- To highlight the achievements of the democratic government since 1994.
- To highlight and profile the progress of individuals, communities and the country which has been enabled by the democratic dispensation.

f Free State Provincial Government x @fsgov @ fsgov d @freestate_government

FREE STATE PROVINCE

2030 NDP LEAVE NO ONE BEHIND

[Source: <https://www.freestateonline.fs.gov.za/news/the-free-state-welcomes-the-30-years-of-democracy-bus/>]

- 4.1 What is the meaning of '30 Years of Democracy'? (2)
- 4.2 What is the advertisement promoting? (1)
- 4.3 4.3.1 According to the text, which province hosted the Bus Project? (1)
- 4.3.2 Mention THREE objectives of the Bus Project. (3)
- 4.4 Name TWO platforms that you can use to contact the Free State provincial government. (2)
- 4.5 Why is the year '1994' important in the calendar of the South African government? (2)
- 4.6 When did the campaign end? (2)

[13]

TOTAL SECTION C: 30

2)

-9-

SECTION D

QUESTION 5

- 5.1 Complete the passage below by giving the correct form of the word in brackets, filling in the missing word, choosing the correct answer, or filling in the correct preposition. Write only the answer next to the question number (5.1.1–5.1.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

On Wednesday, 12 March 2025, the Minister of Finance, Mr Enoch Godongwana, presented his first National Budget Speech after the formation of (5.1.1 the/a) new Government of National Unity (GNU). The Budget Speech (5.1.2 be) delayed from 19 February 2025 following a reported increase in the VAT rate from 15% to 17% that the GNU could not support. The Minister's speech comes at a time (5.1.3 ...) a strained fiscal landscape: high unemployment, constrained revenue growth, mounting pressure from social grants and healthcare, and struggling state-owned entities that ultimately result in escalating (5.1.4 dept/debt) levels.

The International Monetary Fund (5.1.5 give the abbreviation) in its 2024 Article IV Consultation Report dated 30 January 2025, states that:

“(5.1.6 south africa's) economy has continued to face challenges in recent years. Power shortages and rail and port operations disruptions constrained growth (5.1.7 ...) 0.7 per cent in 2023. Activity remained subdued in 2024, given (5.1.8 electionrelated) uncertainty in the year's first half and severe droughts. Nonetheless, power generation was stabilised and following the formation of a reform-oriented Government of National Unity in June, consumer, business, and investor (5.1.9 confidence/confindense) rebounded. Inflation moderated from 5.9 per cent in 2023 to an estimated 4.5 per cent in 2024, with the central bank cutting interest rates by 50 basis points in 2024. While still high, unemployment declined to an estimated 32.8 per cent in 2024. Government deficits remained elevated, pushing the public debt to above 75 percent of GDP (5.1.10 ...) end-2024”.

The Budget Review notes that economic growth is expected to average 1.8% over the next three years and that the country's fiscal strategy remains on course. To boost growth and employment, the government is significantly upscaling its infrastructure delivery programme. Major opportunities exist to reduce the backlog in public infrastructure while creating jobs and boosting economic activity. The regulations for public-private partnerships are to be simplified to attract greater private-sector participation.

(10)

- 5.2 Rewrite the following sentence in the present tense:

On Wednesday, 12 March 2025, the Minister of Finance, Mr Enoch Godongwana, presented his first National Budget Speech.

(2)

- 5.3 Rewrite the following sentence as a tag question:

Power shortages and rail and port operations disruptions constrained growth.

(2)

2)

5.4

Rewrite the following sentences in negative form:

5.4.1 Power generation was stabilised following the formation of a reform-oriented Government of National Unity in June.

5.4.2 Unemployment declined by 32,8 percent.

(2 × 2)

(4)

5.5

Give the antonyms of the following words:

5.5.1 First

5.5.2 High

(2 × 1)

(2)

5.6

Rewrite the following sentence in reported speech:

"The Budget Review notes that economic growth is expected to average 1.8% over the next three years and that the country's fiscal strategy remains on course," he said

(5)

5.7

Rewrite the following sentence in passive voice:

The regulations for public-private partnerships will attract greater private-sector participation.

(2)

5.8

Complete the following table by supplying the missing words. Write only the answer next to the question number (5.8.1–5.8.5) in the ANSWER BOOK.

Adjective	Comparative	Superlative
Average	5.8.1 ...	5.8.2 ...
5.8.3 ...	Greater	6.8.4 ...
High	5.8.5 ...	Highest

(5)

5.9

Use the word 'cut' in TWO sentences to show two distinct meanings. (2 × 2)

(4)

5.10

Identify the underlined parts of speech in the following sentence:

The budget planner **helps** you stay **on top** of your spending, but what about the money **you** put away or use to pay off debts?

(4)

[40]

TOTAL SECTION D:

40

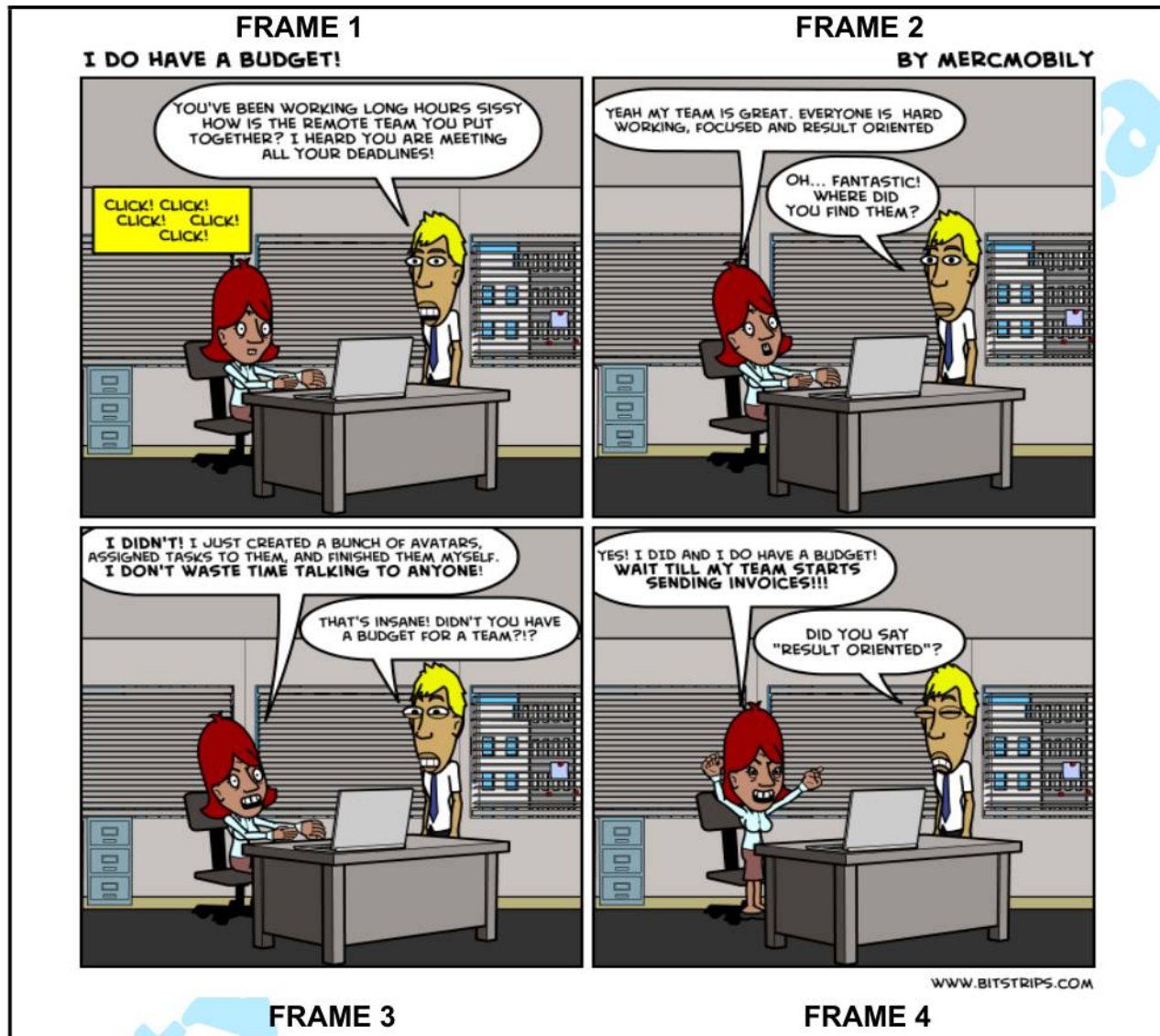
2)

-11-

SECTION E

QUESTION 6

Study the following cartoon and answer the questions below.



- 6.1 6.1.1 Name the type of communication in the cartoon. (1)
- 6.1.2 Give a reason to support your answer. (2)
- 6.2 Who are the characters in the cartoon? (2)
- 6.3 Quote ONE example of slang in FRAME 1. (2)
- 6.4 What is a 'remote team'? (FRAME 1) (2)
- 6.5 Comment on the non-verbal communication in FRAME 2 (2)
- 6.6 Describe the setting of the cartoon in FRAME 2. (2)

2)

-12-

- 6.7 What are 'avatars' referred to in FRAME 3? (2)
- 6.8 Refer to FRAME 3.
- 6.8.1 Is the word 'budget' in FRAME 3 used literally or figuratively? (1)
- 6.8.2 Give a reason to support your answer. (2)
- 6.9 Why is the lady in FRAME 4 standing? (2)
- [20]**

QUESTION 7

Choose a term from COLUMN B that matches a description in COLUMN A. Write only the letter (A–J) next to the question number (7.1–7.10) in the ANSWER BOOK.

COLUMN A		COLUMN B
7.1	Process of sharing information with a large group of people.	A sender
7.2	Communication between two people.	B physical barrier
7.3	Method used to relay information.	C receiver
7.4	Communication within oneself.	D extra personal communication
7.5	The person who the message is intended for.	E horizontal communication
7.6	Communicating with objects or animals.	F interpersonal communication
7.7	Upward or downward movement of information.	G vertical communication
7.8	Process where information is communicated by employees who are in the same level.	H intrapersonal communication
7.9	The one who starts the communication process.	I mass communication
7.10	Natural barriers	J medium

(10 × 1) **[10]**

TOTAL SECTION E: 30
GRAND TOTAL: 140